

Hits n' misses

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MONOPOLY TYCOON

This means business

The most popular strategy games today trace their roots back to boardgames. *Dungeons and Dragons (D&D)* and *Advanced D&D* used to be played with huge rulebooks and dice. Over time several of these boardgames got ported to the PC with great success. Deep Red and Hasbro didn't take long to figure out that *Monopoly* was another

relevant to the people at the time. The best businesses in the 1950s might be sports and music stores, but as time goes by, it might be a better idea to tear them down to start a computer store.

Winning requires being elected as a mayor, reaching a certain sales target, profit margin, or empire value. There's also a survivor-style elimination mode where the true spirit of *Monopoly*—bankrupting your opponent comes into play.

The 3D graphics are colourful and smooth. You can zoom in

and out on buildings and streetlights come on at night, casting shadows in areas the light doesn't hit. Individuals and cars change appearance as time progresses. The music is snazzy and changes with the decades.

It takes about an hour to learn the ropes. After that, this game has you in its grip.

The strategic and tactical possibilities in here are greater than in *SimCity* or *Railroad Tycoon*, and the options open to you are many. The construct is so huge that there is no single way to become rich and dominant. That's the beauty of *Monopoly Tycoon*.

If you played the boardgame in your childhood, do give this PC version a look. With single player and

multiplayer modes, chance cards, dynamic AI and different gameplay scenarios, this game keeps giving.

Strategy/simulation management games might not be everyone's cup of tea, but with interactive city dwellers, multiplayer capabilities, Internet

play and gorgeous 3D graphics, it's time you gave it a look.

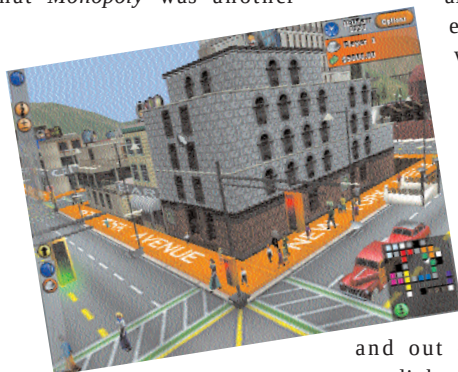
Developer: Deep Red

Genre: Strategy/Simulation

Contact: Milestone Interactive, 022-8381614

Web site: www.monopolytycoon.com

Rating: ★★★★★☆



boardgame begging to be ported to the PC.

Playing a boardgame on a PC introduces you to dynamics that you will not find in a regular boardgame. *Monopoly Tycoon* is a 3D real-time management multiplayer game that simulates a city, right down to its individual citizens. You start off as an entrepreneur in a city back in the 1930s and grow with it. The only driving motive here is the American dream: grow rich and powerful.

The game is not only about money circulation, but also about being competitive enough to outdo your opponents by building properties and businesses that are

SUPERCAR STREET CHALLENGE

The Fast and the Futile

It's time to squash this lemon in the junkyard. If you've seen *The Fast and the Furious* or *Gone in 60 Seconds*, it's easy to make a parallel between supercars and souped up PCs. Both embody the best in technology and are over-clocked by enthusiasts to deliver the best performance. Exakt Entertainment's *Supercar Street Challenge* makes a desperate attempt at tapping into some of that, letting you take to the wheel of some of the best cars and even redesign them.

But in plain racing terms, this game is a flat tire. It allows you to shape the car any way you want, but that's all it does. The changes you can make to the car are cosmetic; there is no relation to speed, braking, acceleration and handling. Controls are largely arcade-oriented, which is fine, but the lame physics make it hard to

appreciate it. You keep plowing through lampposts, trees, statues and an assortment of other obstacles. Since there is no damage system, here's a simple strategy—the best way to win is to bounce off walls and keep the pedal on the



metal all the while. The menu system seems like it was ported straight from the console, and is unintuitive and laborious. The lack of any obstacles undermines the sense of speed you have—there is no fear of being slowed down at all.

Supercar lets you race through several major cities,